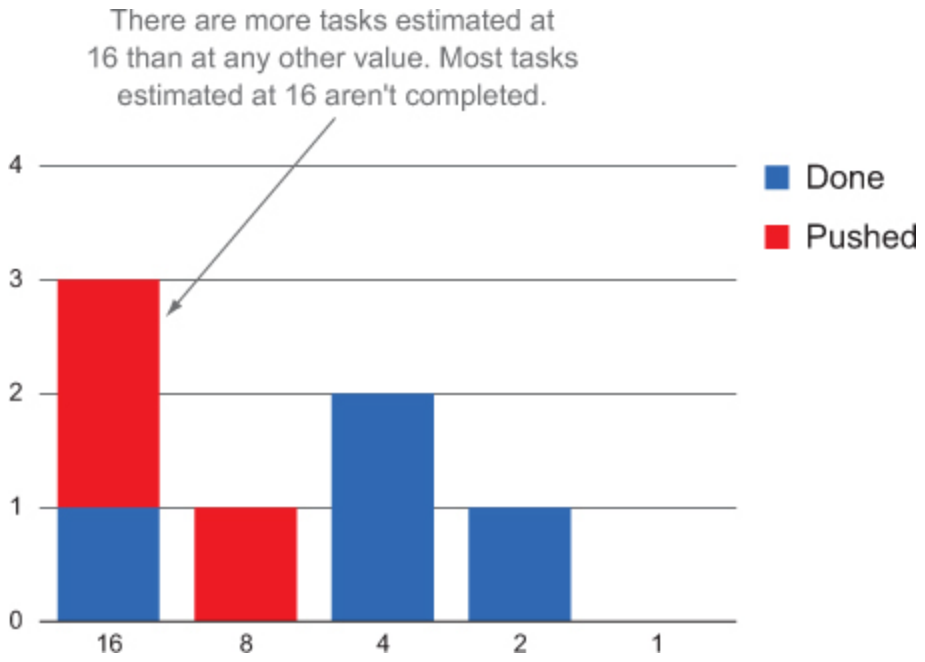
perhaps something was wrong with their estimations. To try to dig deeper into that, they decided to look at the distribution of estimations for a sprint. They used base 2 estimating with the maximum estimation being a 16, so the possible estimation values for a task were 1, 2, 4, 8, and 16. The typical distribution across sprints looked something like figure 5.17.

Figure 5.17. The distribution of estimates for a sprint: how many are completed and how many get pushed to the next sprint?



As shown in their analysis, most of their tasks were pretty big and the bigger tasks tended to not always get done. These big features were also pushing releases farther apart because the team was missing their sprint goals and had to postpone a release until the tasks they wanted to release were done. If they could get their tasks back to an appropriate size, then perhaps they could get their velocity on track and have more frequent, smaller releases.

The team started to break their stories down further; anything that was estimated as a 16 was broken down into smaller, more manageable chunks of work. After a few sprints they noticed that their velocity started to increase, as shown in figure 5.18.